Video Prompt: "George Builds a Boat" (Curious George, 4 min 13 s)

Master Prompt (one-paragraph version)

A 4-minute 2D animated children's cartoon in classic Curious George style: soft, hand-drawn-look digital animation, clean dark outlines, flat bright colors with gentle shading, sunny summer palette (sky blue, grass green, sunflower yellow, red). A small brown monkey named George visits a lakeside park with his friend, the Man with the Yellow Hat, on the day of a toy-boat contest. A teenage boy shows off a sleek green-and-white toy sailboat. George's first boat, a raft of toy blocks, sinks off the dock. He gathers odds and ends in a red bucket, imagines winning, then dumps everything in the water to test what floats. He sketches ideas (a sailboat, a catamaran, a steamboat, a fan boat) and dives underwater to watch things float and sink, alongside a curious duck. The boy's fancy boat takes on water and leaks, and George figures out why. George builds a quirky raft from floating corks, wood pieces, a bottle, and a pinwheel. At the outdoor ceremony on a red stage, the boy wins the blue ribbon, and George proudly shows his homemade boat to the Man with the Yellow Hat. The mood is warm, playful, curious, and educational (buoyancy, floating vs. sinking, trial and error). Light orchestral and acoustic kids' score. 16:9, 24 fps.

Style Guide

- **Animation:** 2D, digital, made to look hand-drawn. Bold outlines, simple shapes, smooth limited animation, expressive faces.
- **Palette:** Saturated primary colors. Cyan-blue water, lime and emerald grass, bright yellow dock and hat, red-and-white stripes, rounded leafy green trees, pale blue sky with puffy white clouds.
- **Camera:** Mostly static or gently panning shots. Wide establishing shots, medium two-shots, close-ups for reactions. Occasional top-down views of the dock and insert shots of hands and objects.
- **Effects:** Water ripples, splashes, floating debris, underwater bubbles, steam puffs. Imagination sequences sit inside a soft pink cloud with blurred edges.
- **Tone:** Gentle, optimistic, curious, kid-friendly. No danger and no villains.

Characters

Character	Look	Role
George	Small brown monkey with a tan face, big round eyes, and a curl of hair on top. No tail. Very expressive.	Curious hero who learns by trial and error
Man with the Yellow Hat	Tall, slim man in an all-yellow outfit: wide-brimmed yellow hat, yellow shirt and tie, yellow pants, brown boots. Carries a folded yellow beach umbrella.	George's caretaker. Calm, encouraging
Teenage boy	Lanky teen in a dark blue baseball cap, red-and-white striped long-sleeve shirt, and blue jeans. Rides a red bicycle.	Contest entrant with a fancy green-hulled toy sailboat
Older couple	Woman in a straw hat and blue overalls; bald man with glasses, green shirt, and suspenders	Appear in the imagined contest and as judges/presenters at the ceremony
Squirrel	Brown cartoon squirrel on a tree branch	Comic reaction shot
Duck	White duck with an orange bill	Underwater companion
Park crowd	Families, picnickers, a sunbather under a yellow umbrella, audience in bleachers	Background life

Key Props

- Green-hulled toy sailboat with a white sail, portholes, a brown cabin, and a blue pennant (the boy's)
- Raft made of colorful toy blocks (George's first attempt)
- Red-and-orange flame-pattern bucket full of odds and ends: wooden spools, sticks, a toy windmill/flower, corks, plastic toys, bottle caps
- Spiral notepad with red-pencil sketches of boats
- George's final boat: a raft of corks and wood pieces with a small bottle mast and a pinwheel
- Blue first-place ribbon rosette
- Red ceremony stage with a gold rope, a wooden podium with a microphone, and blue bleachers

Scene-by-Scene Breakdown

Scene 1: Arrival at the Lake (0:00–0:12)

- **0:00–0:05:** Wide aerial establishing shot of a sunny park around a bright blue lake. Winding paths, a small yellow car, tents and stalls in the distance, ducks on the water.
- **0:06–0:11:** Ground level. The Man with the Yellow Hat walks along the grassy shore carrying a folded umbrella and a picnic basket. George hops beside him with a small red bucket. Picnickers sit at tables, and a woman sunbathes in a red lounge chair under a yellow umbrella.

Scene 2: Meeting the Boy and His Boat (0:12–0:29)

- **0:12:** Close-up of the teenage boy in a cap, smiling proudly and holding a small green remote or box.
- **0:15:** Cutaway of a sleek green-and-white sailboat gliding across sparkling water and leaving a white wake.
- **0:18:** Two-shot. The boy and George watch admiringly. George clasps his hands with excitement.
- **0:21–0:24:** Wide shot on the yellow wooden dock under a big tree. The Man with the Yellow Hat gestures and explains, the boy listens, and George looks eager. A picnic basket sits on the dock.
- **0:27:** Close-up of the Man with the Yellow Hat smiling and encouraging, umbrella over his shoulder.

Scene 3: First Attempt Sinks (0:30–0:47)

- **0:30:** George leans off the dock and launches a raft of colorful toy blocks onto the water.
- **0:33:** A squirrel on a branch peers down curiously (comic reaction).
- **0:36:** George stands waist-deep in the water and watches the block raft drift.
- **0:39–0:45:** The raft slowly sinks beneath the surface. George's face falls into a disappointed frown as the blocks blur underwater.

Scene 4: Gathering Materials (0:48–1:13)

- **0:48:** Wide shot of the park. George carries a big red bucket along the dock. A white toy sailboat stands on the dock nearby.
- **0:51–0:54:** George waves next to the sailboat, then squints and puzzles over items in his bucket: a toy windmill, sticks, spools.
- **0:57–1:00:** Top-down view of the dock. George sits among his supplies: toy blocks, the sailboat, the red bucket, and a block structure.
- **1:03–1:12:** Close-ups at dock level. George rubs his chin and thinks, looking at his bucket and a green-and-red toy-block chassis. A thought bubble appears showing a wooden boat floating.

Scene 5: Testing What Floats (1:15–1:22)

- **1:15–1:21:** George, chest-deep in the lake, shrugs and gestures in confusion as a flat wooden plank bobs past. The dock, bucket, and sailboat are behind him.

Scene 6: The Daydream (1:24–1:35)

- **1:24–1:33:** Imagination sequence inside a soft pink cloud. The woman in the straw hat holds a wooden boat, the old man with glasses holds a fancy multi-masted model ship, and the boy holds a slim toy boat. George, in the foreground, first smiles dreamily and then looks worried as he compares.
- **1:36:** Back to reality. George looks at a plank floating near the dock.

Scene 7: Dumping the Bucket (1:39–1:50)

- **1:39:** Close-up overhead shot of the bucket's contents: wooden sticks, spools, corks, a plastic flower, bottle caps.
- **1:42:** George splashes into the water and tips the bucket over.
- **1:45–1:48:** All the items scatter on the water. Some float (wooden pieces, corks, a yellow cup, a red disc) and some bob or sink. This is a buoyancy test.

Scene 8: Thinking and Sketching (1:51–2:12)

- **1:51:** Empty shot of the grassy shoreline and sky.
- **1:54:** George holds a cork in one hand and a red disc in the other, comparing them thoughtfully.
- **1:57:** Imagined boat: a white catamaran with yellow and blue sails skimming the water.
- **2:00:** George lies on the bank and sketches on a notepad as a toy catamaran sails past.
- **2:03:** He imagines a red-and-white steamboat with portholes and a puffing smokestack, while his notepad hangs in the foreground.
- **2:06:** George taps a pencil to his lips, thinking, as steam clouds drift.
- **2:09–2:12:** He imagines a red fan boat with a big rear propeller, then stands in the water writing notes.

Scene 9: Underwater Discovery (2:15–2:25)

- **2:15–2:24:** Underwater in turquoise water. George holds his breath with puffed cheeks and points up at a red toy boat hull on the surface. A clear bowl or dish floats above him. A duck paddles down beside him and peers curiously. George shrugs at the duck.

Scene 10: Design Sketches (2:24–2:34)

- **2:24–2:33:** Sketch montage on the yellow dock. Notepad pages drawn in red pencil slide into frame one after another: a sailboat, a catamaran, a steamboat with smoke, a fan boat.

Scene 11: Building and the Leaky Boat (2:36–3:12)

- **2:36:** George sits on the dock surrounded by his sketches and floating materials, working on his creation. People picnic in the background.
- **2:39:** The boy rides up on a red bicycle as George crouches over his work.
- **2:42–2:48:** The boy chats with George. George listens wide-eyed, then grins.
- **2:51–2:57:** Under a tree, the boy examines his green sailboat. Water pours out of the hull and he looks dismayed: it leaks.
- **3:00:** George, leaning from the water at the dock edge, gives a skeptical, knowing look.
- **3:03–3:06:** The boy holds up his boat, worried, then talks it over.
- **3:09–3:12:** Close-up of the dock planks, then the green hull's portholes. George's finger points at a porthole and finds the leak.

Scene 12: Fixing and Testing (3:15–3:33)

- **3:15:** The boy kneels on the dock beside George and his materials. Park visitors and a picnic basket are in the background.
- **3:18–3:21:** At the dock, the boy launches his sailboat and it floats upright. George stands in the water watching. The boy lifts the boat to check it.
- **3:24–3:27:** Under the tree, the boy smiles holding his fixed sailboat. George peeks out from behind the trunk, unsure.
- **3:30:** George worries over his own finished boat: a raft of corks and wood with a bottle mast, a spool, and a pinwheel.
- **3:33:** The boy stands proudly with his boat, ready for the contest.

Scene 13: The Contest Ceremony (3:36–4:13)

- **3:36–3:39:** Wide shot of the lakeside ceremony. A red stage with a gold rope barrier, a wooden podium and microphone, blue bleachers full of spectators, and a lineup of contestants holding their boats. The Man with the Yellow Hat stands in the foreground.
- **3:42:** George proudly holds up his homemade raft boat. The boy holds his sailboat, and the older couple stand at the podium.
- **3:45–3:57:** On the bleacher steps, the boy is awarded the blue first-place ribbon and pins it to his shirt. George stands beside the Man with the Yellow Hat holding his cork boat, then watches the boy celebrate.

- **4:00–4:03:** Over-the-shoulder shot from the Man with the Yellow Hat. The boy beams, shows off his blue ribbon, and gives a thumbs-up toward himself.
- **4:06:** The Man with the Yellow Hat turns, smiling.
- **4:09–4:13:** Final shot. George happily holds up his handmade boat (corks, wood, bottle, pinwheel) to the Man with the Yellow Hat. Both smile warmly. Fade out.

Audio Direction

- **Music:** Light, bouncy orchestral and acoustic children's score with plucked strings, woodwinds, and soft percussion. Curious "thinking" motifs during experiments, a dreamy shimmer for the imagination cloud, and a celebratory fanfare at the ceremony.
- **Narration:** A warm, gentle narrator voice (classic storybook tone) describes George's thoughts. George communicates only through monkey sounds and expressions.
- **Dialogue:** Friendly, simple adult and teen voices: the boy explaining his boat, the Man with the Yellow Hat encouraging, an announcer at the podium.
- **Sound effects:** Splashes, plops, gurgles, bubbles underwater, a duck quack, water pouring from the leaky hull, a steamboat whistle and puffs in the daydream, crowd applause at the ceremony.

Themes and Learning Goal

- **Science:** Buoyancy, which materials float or sink, and why a boat leaks.
- **Process:** Trial and error, observing, sketching designs, testing, and improving.
- **Social-emotional:** Disappointment turning into persistence, helping a friend, being proud of your own creation even when you don't win.

Technical Specs

- Aspect ratio 16:9, 24 fps (23.976), about 4:13 long
- Kid-safe, G-rated